

Screening for Five-Year Growth Stocks

How to set the screener's filters to find companies that are growing fast, are profitable or on their way to profitability, generate positive cash flow, and have strong analyst support. Includes why forward P/E matters and sample results from public data.

Compiled September 2026 · Educational guidance, not personalized financial advice

Most of the filters you need are in the **Company Growth** and **Management & Growth** panels. Analyst ratings are not in those top panels. Scroll further down the screener to the category named something like **Analyst Opinions** or **Equity Summary Score**.

The values below are reasonable starting points, not fixed rules. A screen narrows the list, so loosen or tighten the values based on how many stocks come back.

Quick start: the 8 core filters

- Revenue Growth TTM vs. Prior TTM $\geq 15\%$
- Revenue Growth 3 Year $\geq 15\%$
- EPS Forward Long Term Growth $\geq 15\%$
- Gross Profit Margin (TTM) $\geq 40\%$
- Free Cash Flow > 0
- P/E Next Year Estimate 0–60
- Equity Summary Score Bullish or better
- Market Capitalization $\geq \$2B$

1 Growth (the main filter)

Panel: **Company Growth**

FILTER	VALUE	WHY
Revenue Growth → TTM vs. Prior TTM	$\geq 15\%$	Growing now
Revenue Growth → 3 Year	$\geq 15\%$	Growth has lasted several years
EPS Growth → Forward Long Term Growth (3-5 Yrs)	$\geq 15\%$	Analysts' view of the next five years, which matches the time frame
EPS Growth → Proj Next Yr vs. This Yr	$\geq 15\%$	Earnings expected to keep rising
Cash Flow Growth Rate → TTM vs. Prior TTM	$> 0\%$	Cash generation is getting better

2 Profitable, or getting there

Panels: **Management & Growth**, and P/E in **Company Value**

FILTER	VALUE	WHY
Gross Profit Margin (TTM)	≥ 40%	A strong business model even before it turns profitable
Operating Margin → TTM	> 0%	Already profitable (strict screen only)
Operating Margin → TTM/5 Year Average	> 1	Margins are improving, which catches companies on the way to profitability
Profit Margin → Most Recent Qtr	> 0%	Profitable in the latest quarter, even if the TTM figure is still negative
P/E → Next Year Estimate	0–60	A positive forward P/E means analysts expect profits next year. A simple way to find companies close to profitability.

Run two screens. The *strict* screen uses Operating Margin TTM > 0. The *emerging* screen drops that filter and keeps only Most Recent Qtr profit margin > 0 and Next Year P/E > 0.

3 Positive cash flow

FILTER	VALUE	PANEL
Free Cash Flow	> 0	Management & Growth
Price/Cash Flow Ratio	0–40	Company Value

4 Analyst ratings

Scroll down on the screener page, plus the **Earnings** panel

FILTER	VALUE	WHY
Equity Summary Score	Bullish or Very Bullish	Fidelity's combined analyst score from LSEG StarMine
Analyst consensus rating (if listed)	Buy / Strong Buy	Broad analyst support
Number of analysts	≥ 5	The rating isn't based on one or two opinions
Positive Earnings Surprises → 90 Days	Checked	Beating estimates is a good sign

5 Quality and safety checks

FILTER	VALUE	WHY
Market Capitalization	$\geq \$2B$	Avoids very small, thinly covered stocks (use $\geq \$500M$ if you accept more risk)
Debt to Capital Ratio (Most Recent Qtr)	$< 50\%$	Growth isn't paid for with heavy debt
Current Ratio (Most Recent Qtr)	> 1.2	Enough short-term cash to pay short-term bills
Interest Coverage (Most Recent Qtr)	> 5	Can comfortably cover interest payments
% of Institutional Ownership → Current	$\geq 40\%$	Large investors hold it
Volume → 90 Day Average	$\geq 500K$	Easy to buy and sell
PEG Ratio	< 2	Keeps you from overpaying for the growth

6 Optional momentum check

- **Technicals:** price above its 50-day or 200-day SMA (the moving average of the closing price over that many days).
- **Performance & Volatility:** % Below 52 Week High $< 25\%$.

7 How to use it

1. **Start small.** Begin with the 8 core filters in the quick-start box. If you check everything at once, you'll probably get zero results.
2. **Adjust until you have 20–50 stocks.** Too few: lower growth to 10% or market cap to \$500M. Too many: raise growth to 20–25%.
3. **Research the list by hand.** A screen only produces candidates. For each one, read the latest earnings report, the company's competitive advantages, how fast margins are improving, and how much the share count is being diluted (check the Shares Outstanding trend and stock-based compensation).
4. **Re-run the screen quarterly** after earnings season, because growth figures change.

8 Why P/E (Next Year's Estimate) matters for growth stocks

P/E (Next Year's Estimate), also called the **forward P/E**, is the current share price divided by the earnings per share (EPS) that analysts, on average, expect the company to earn in its next fiscal year:

$$\text{Forward P/E} = \text{Share price} \div \text{Analysts' consensus EPS estimate for next year}$$

The usual P/E (*Price/TTM Earnings*) divides by the last twelve months of earnings, which have already happened. The forward P/E divides by earnings that are expected. For a slow, steady company the two are close. For a growth company they can be very different, and the forward P/E is usually the more useful number.

1. The trailing P/E makes fast growers look too expensive

When earnings grow quickly, last year's earnings understate what the company earns now. Take a \$100 stock that earned \$2 per share last year and is expected to earn \$3.33 next year. Its trailing P/E is 50, which looks expensive, but its forward P/E is 30. The gap between the two shows how much growth the market expects. The screen results in section 9 show this clearly:

STOCK	TRAILING P/E	FORWARD P/E	WHAT IT MEANS
Samsara (IOT)	248.4	40.3	Looks very expensive on past earnings, much less so on expected earnings
Shopify (SHOP)	99.7	59.9	Earnings expected to rise about two-thirds
HubSpot (HUBS)	77.1	12.9	Very large gap. Part of it is accounting (see limitations below)
Microsoft (MSFT)	27.8	21.2	Mature grower: a small gap

2. It identifies companies "on their way to profitability"

A company that lost money over the last year has no meaningful trailing P/E. If analysts expect a profit next year, its forward P/E is positive. That is why the screen uses **Next Year Estimate > 0**: it lets in companies that are just becoming profitable and keeps out companies with no profit in sight. **Zeta Global (ZETA)** in section 9 is an example: it has no trailing P/E because it was not profitable over the last twelve months, but its forward P/E is 25.1.

3. It is a guardrail against overpaying

Growth stocks often trade at high prices. Capping the forward P/E (at 60 in this screen) removes stocks priced so high that even strong growth may not justify the price. The **PEG ratio** takes this a step further by dividing the P/E by the expected growth rate, so a PEG under 2 means the price is reasonable for the growth expected.

4. It shows what the market is betting on

Trailing P/E $\div$ forward P/E is roughly $1 + \text{next year's expected earnings growth}$. Samsara's $248 \div 40 \approx 6$ means analysts expect earnings to rise about six-fold. That is only worth paying for if the company delivers, so the forward P/E also tells you what has to go right.

Limitations of the forward P/E

- **It is an estimate.** Analysts are often too optimistic, and estimates get cut. Check whether estimates have been rising or falling over the last 90 days.
- **Estimates are usually "adjusted" EPS**, which leaves out costs such as stock-based compensation. This is why some software companies (like HubSpot above) show a very large gap between trailing and forward P/E.
- **It covers only one year.** For a five-year view, use it together with PEG and Forward Long Term EPS Growth (3–5 Yrs).
- **Compare within an industry.** A forward P/E of 25 is cheap for fast-growing software and expensive for a utility.
- **Cyclical companies can be a trap.** Miners and chipmakers show their lowest forward P/E at the *peak* of a cycle, when earnings are temporarily high.

9 Sample results: running the screen on public data

To show what the screen produces, Claude (an AI assistant) ran it on the free, public **Finviz stock screener** (finviz.com) on **September 22, 2026**. These results come from publicly available data, not from Fidelity. They are a point-in-time snapshot, not recommendations.

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stocks pass the 8 core filters

32

stocks pass the full screen

How the Fidelity filters were mapped

Finviz does not have every Fidelity filter, so the closest equivalent was used where needed:

FIDELITY FILTER (THIS GUIDE)	FINVIZ FILTER USED
Revenue Growth TTM vs. Prior TTM $\geq 15\%$; 3 Year $\geq 15\%$	Sales growth TTM $> 15\%$; Sales growth 3Y $> 15\%$
EPS Forward Long Term Growth $\geq 15\%$; Proj Next Yr vs. This Yr $\geq 15\%$	EPS growth next 5Y $> 15\%$; EPS growth next year $> 15\%$
Gross Profit Margin $\geq 40\%$; Operating Margin TTM > 0	Gross margin $> 40\%$; Operating margin positive
Free Cash Flow > 0	Price/FCF under 100 (implies positive free cash flow)
P/E Next Year Estimate 0–60	Forward P/E under 60
Equity Summary Score Bullish or better	Analyst recommendation Buy or better (Finviz has no Equity Summary Score)
Positive earnings surprise	EPS surprise positive (last quarter)
Market cap $\geq \$2B$	Market cap mid-cap and over ($\geq \$2B$)
Debt to Capital $< 50\%$	Debt/Equity under 1 (equivalent)
Current Ratio > 1.2	Current ratio over 1 (closest option)

FIDELITY FILTER (THIS GUIDE)	FINVIZ FILTER USED
Institutional ownership $\geq$ 40%; 90-day volume $\geq$ 500K; PEG < 2	Same thresholds
Interest Coverage > 5	<i>Not applied</i> (no Finviz filter)

The 32 stocks that pass the full screen

P/E = trailing twelve months. Fwd P/E = next year's estimate. EPS next 5Y = analysts' estimated annual EPS growth. Sales past 5Y = actual annual sales growth. "-" = not available.

Semiconductors, hardware and solar

TICKER	COMPANY	MKT CAP	P/E	FWD P/E	PEG	EPS NEXT 5Y	SALES PAST 5Y
NVDA	NVIDIA Corp	\$5.52T	28.93	14.54	0.22	64.79%	66.90%
AVGO	Broadcom Inc	\$1.74T	46.54	18.94	0.29	64.81%	21.74%
SNDK	Sandisk Corp	\$276B	25.89	7.23	0.13	54.54%	-
ANET	Arista Networks Inc	\$259B	64.69	39.25	1.35	28.98%	31.19%
CRDO	Credo Technology Group Holding Ltd	\$36.2B	68.72	19.96	0.38	52.78%	86.80%
NVMI	Nova Ltd	\$11.8B	46.13	26.98	1.11	24.38%	26.73%
RMBS	Rambus Inc	\$11.4B	48.17	27.79	1.15	24.26%	23.50%
FSLR	First Solar Inc	\$21.6B	12.38	8.59	0.31	27.55%	14.00%

Software and internet

TICKER	COMPANY	MKT CAP	P/E	FWD P/E	PEG	EPS NEXT 5Y	SALES PAST 5Y
MSFT	Microsoft Corp	\$3.70T	27.75	21.21	1.15	18.41%	14.57%
SHOP	Shopify Inc	\$190B	99.66	59.92	1.81	33.06%	31.58%
RDDT	Reddit Inc	\$29.9B	36.19	21.94	0.43	50.81%	57.27%
IOT	Samsara Inc	\$22.4B	248.44	40.29	1.42	28.34%	45.30%
GWRE	Guidewire Software Inc	\$12.3B	92.35	28.19	1.09	25.88%	14.70%
HUBS	HubSpot Inc	\$10.9B	77.12	12.91	0.47	27.63%	28.81%
ZETA	Zeta Global Holdings Corp	\$7.6B	-	25.11	1.00	25.23%	28.80%
GLBE	Global E Online Ltd	\$7.0B	47.40	25.54	0.32	79.73%	47.81%
YOU	Clear Secure Inc	\$5.3B	26.64	17.77	0.48	36.75%	31.30%
MNDY	Monday.Com Ltd	\$3.6B	36.22	12.71	0.58	21.83%	50.21%

Healthcare

TICKER	COMPANY	MKT CAP	P/E	FWD P/E	PEG	EPS NEXT 5Y	SALES PAST 5Y
DXCM	Dexcom Inc	\$33.8B	35.34	28.69	1.35	21.18%	19.33%
PODD	Insulet Corp	\$9.7B	27.63	18.08	0.78	23.16%	24.53%
KNSA	Kiniksa Pharmaceuticals International Plc	\$6.1B	79.31	38.02	0.70	54.65%	-
VCEL	Vericel Corp	\$2.1B	87.02	46.48	0.76	61.02%	17.34%

Consumer, industrials and financials

TICKER	COMPANY	MKT CAP	P/E	FWD P/E	PEG	EPS NEXT 5Y	SALES PAST 5Y
SN	SharkNinja Inc	\$23.8B	34.53	22.27	1.31	16.96%	18.37%
ONON	On Holding AG	\$9.7B	19.70	14.60	0.41	35.49%	51.61%
ATAT	Atour Lifestyle Holdings Ltd ADR	\$3.8B	16.37	11.82	0.59	20.20%	43.10%
LOAR	Loar Holdings Inc	\$6.0B	90.34	39.68	1.78	22.26%	-
SEZL	Sezzle Inc	\$3.7B	23.92	16.48	0.54	30.32%	50.26%

Mining (see the caution below)

TICKER	COMPANY	MKT CAP	P/E	FWD P/E	PEG	EPS NEXT 5Y	SALES PAST 5Y
AGI	Alamos Gold Inc	\$15.2B	13.06	12.78	0.33	38.19%	19.31%
HL	Hecla Mining Co	\$12.8B	24.40	18.41	0.70	26.41%	14.97%
ARIS	Aris Mining Corp	\$4.1B	14.43	6.48	0.17	38.02%	18.87%
ERO	Ero Copper Corp	\$3.9B	12.59	7.94	0.29	27.54%	19.38%
SVM	Silvercorp Metals Inc	\$2.7B	119.11	8.69	0.24	36.45%	17.93%

What stands out

- **Technology dominates.** 17 of the 32 are chip, hardware, software or internet companies, many of them tied to AI spending, which is where fast, profitable growth is concentrated in 2026. A portfolio built only from this list would be heavily concentrated in one theme.
- **The miners probably don't belong.** Gold, silver and copper miners pass because metal prices are high, not because the businesses are structurally growing. Their earnings can fall sharply when prices drop. To exclude them, add a sector filter that removes Basic Materials.
- **Some estimates are extreme.** Very low PEG ratios (SNDK 0.13, NVDA 0.22, AVGO 0.29) come from analysts projecting 50%+ yearly EPS growth, which rarely lasts five years. Treat these numbers with extra caution.
- **Well-known names are missing from the full screen.** Companies such as Meta, Eli Lilly, ServiceNow and MercadoLibre pass the core filters but fail at least one of the stricter ones (for example PEG, debt, or the last quarter's earnings surprise). Failing a filter doesn't disqualify a company. It just means you should look at why it failed.

The other 60 stocks that pass only the 8 core filters

Technology (24)	TSM, SKHY, ASML, STX, NOW, SNOW, DDOG, MDB, ZS, DT, SAIL, FROG, ESTC, PCOR, APPF, TTAN, KVYO, DAVE, RELY, WK, BRZE, GRND, AVPT, FLYW
Healthcare (11)	LLY, ISRG, ARGX, ONC, ALNY, GMAB, NBIX, HALO, HNGE, WAY, HRMY
Basic Materials (9)	NEM, B, GFI, KGC, PAAS, IAG, AG, AUGO, BTG
Financial (7)	KKR, BAM, AJG, IBKR, NP, WT, SII
Communication Services (3)	META, APP, TKO
Consumer Cyclical (3)	MELI, DASH, BIRK
Industrials (2)	HEI, HEI-A
Energy (1)	VNOM

Source: Finviz.com stock screener, data retrieved September 22, 2026. Market data changes daily; re-run the screen before acting on any of these names.

Disclaimer. This is educational guidance, not personalized financial advice. Check it against your own risk tolerance and diversification.